HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't let my guard down"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't let my guard down." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What facts do I know, and what am I assuming?
- ☐ What evidence does not fit my fear?
- ☐ What else could explain this person's behavior?
- ☐ Is an old experience shaping my expectation?
- ☐ What boundary would help me make a measured choice?
- ☐ What small step fits this person's actual track record?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ When I am afraid, I can put my trust in God.
- ☐ I do not have to face every difficulty alone.
- ☐ Some people will respond to me with kindness and care.
- ☐ I can receive help without assuming there is a hidden motive.
- ☐ Past betrayal does not mean every relationship will end in betrayal.
- ☐ I can allow trust to grow through small experiences of dependable care.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 3:5–6**
  "Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight."
- ☐ **Psalm 56:3–4**
  "When I am afraid, I put my trust in You. In God, whose word I praise— in God I trust. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?"
- ☐ **Ecclesiastes 4:9–10**
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"

- [ ] Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- [ ] John 15:12
  "This is My commandment, that you love one another as I have loved you."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Trust and support log: Each day, record one time someone showed kindness, kept a promise, listened, or offered help. Describe what I allowed myself to receive and what I learned.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  For example, a personalized adaptation of Psalm 56:3 (based on BSB) is: "When Sarah is afraid, she puts her trust in You."
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

Choose a modest, ordinary situation. These exercises do not require revealing private information or approaching anyone who has threatened, coerced, or abused you. A respectful response is useful evidence; a boundary violation is useful evidence too.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- [ ] Accept one small offer of help. Choose a person who has shown reliability. Accept ordinary help, such as help with a task, and notice what actually happens.
- [ ] Ask someone to listen. Tell a caring friend about a modest everyday concern and ask for a few minutes of listening. Compare their actual response with what I predicted.
- [ ] Make room for companionship. Invite a dependable friend to a short walk, coffee, or another comfortable shared activity. Notice moments of warmth or connection.
- [ ] Acknowledge dependable care. Thank someone for a specific way they have supported me. Write down how it feels to recognize and receive that care.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Review what you learned; bring this page to counseling if you are attending.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie “I can't let my guard down”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Care or support I received
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't let my guard down.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, when I am afraid, help me put my trust in You. Heal the hurts that have taught me to expect betrayal. Help me recognize people who show kindness and faithfulness, receive their support, and take small steps toward friendship. Teach me to give and receive love, and remind me that I do not have to carry every burden alone. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.